

Order Coleoptera continued

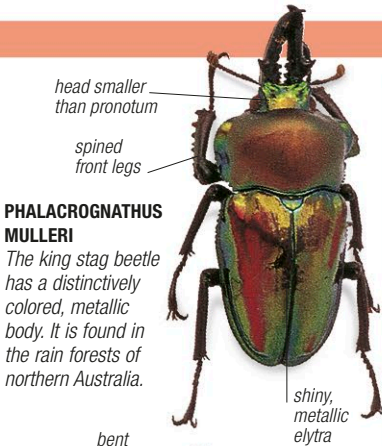
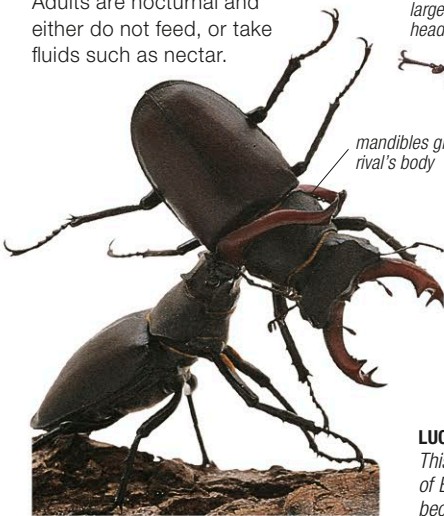
Family Lucanidae

Stag beetles

Occurrence 1,300 spp. worldwide, in deciduous woodland and forests; in and on trees

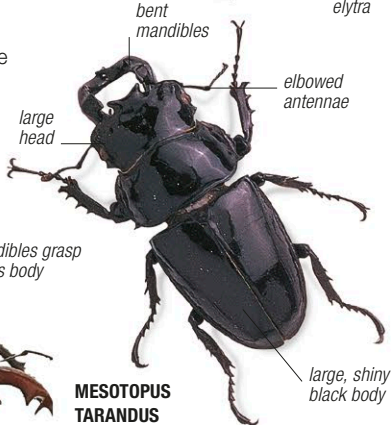


Stag beetles are smooth, black or reddish brown, and mostly 1/4–3 1/4 in (0.6–8.5 cm) long. Males are larger than females and have enlarged mandibles used in male-to-male combat over females. Eggs are laid on decaying tree stumps or roots, and larvae pupate inside a cell of chewed wood fibers. Adults are nocturnal and either do not feed, or take fluids such as nectar.



PHALACROGNATHUS MULLERI

The king stag beetle has a distinctively colored, metallic body. It is found in the rain forests of northern Australia.



MESOTOPUS TARANDUS

Found in the forests of Africa, this species has large, toothed mandibles, bent almost at right angles.

LUCANUS CERVUS

This stag beetle is found in the oak woodland of Europe. It flies after dark. The species is becoming more rare due to loss of habitat.

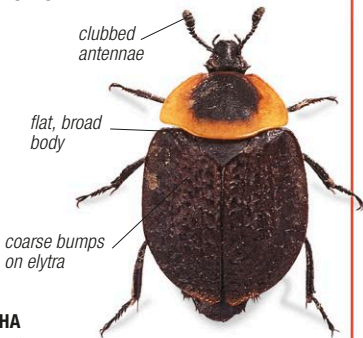
Family Silphidae

Carrion beetles

Occurrence 250 spp. worldwide, mainly in Northern Hemisphere; on ground near carcasses, dung, and fungi



Carrion beetles are usually flat and soft-bodied, 5/32–1 3/4 in (0.4–4.5 cm) long. They are black or brown, often with bright yellow or red markings. In carcass-burying species, such as *Nicrophorus* (burying beetles), the elytra are shortened, exposing a few abdominal segments. These beetles bury corpses of small animals and lay eggs on them. Adults often feed larvae on regurgitated carrion.



SILPHA AMERICANA

Like all members of its family, this beetle is attracted by the odor of carrion. It is found in North America and has a distinctive broad shape with fairly bright coloration.

Family Staphylinidae

Rove beetles

Occurrence 29,000 spp. worldwide; on ground, in soil, fungi, leaf litter, decaying plants, carrion, ant colonies



Most rove beetles are small—usually under 3/4 in (2 cm) in length—smooth, and elongated. They are often brown or black, although some have bright colors and a sculptured body surface. They all have short elytra, with hindwings folded beneath them, and an exposed abdomen. The smaller species tend to be diurnal, while the larger ones are nocturnal. Eggs are laid in soil, fungi, or leaf litter.



STAPHYLINUS OLENS

Known as the devil's coach horse, this is a large, black European species, 3/4–1 1/2 in (2–3.4 cm) long. If threatened, it assumes a scorpionlike posture by curving its abdomen upward.

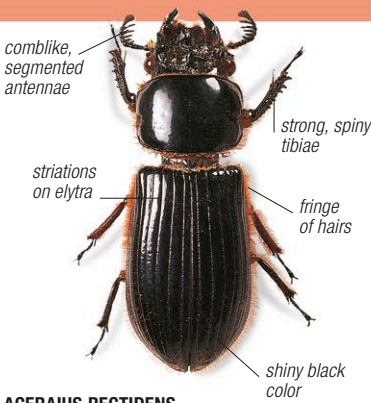
Family Passalidae

Bess beetles

Occurrence 500 spp. in tropical regions, mainly woodland of South America and Asia; in dead wood



Also called patent-leather or betsy beetles, these insects are shiny black or brown, with a flat body that is 3/8–3 1/4 in (1–8.5 cm) long. The elytra have noticeable striations, and the head often has a short horn. Adults make high-pitched sounds in aggression or during courtship. Eggs are laid in dead wood.



ACERIAUS RECTIDENS

Found in the woodland of Southeast Asia, this beetle has curled, 10-segmented antennae, and a short peg on the head.

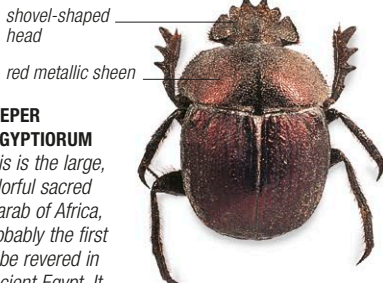
Family Scarabaeidae

Scarab beetles

Occurrence 16,500 spp. worldwide; on dung, carrion, fungi, vegetation, under bark, in ant or termite nests

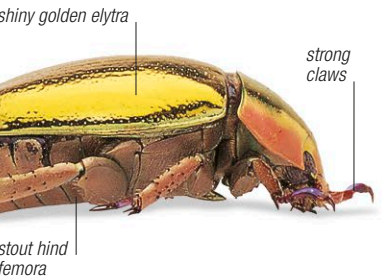


Members of this family are extremely varied in shape, size, and color; subfamilies include dung beetles, Hercules beetles, and leaf chafers. The body length ranges from 1/16–6 1/2 in (0.2–17 cm). The ends of the antennae have a distinct club made up of 3–7 flat, movable plates. Males of many species have an enlarged head or horns to fight over mates. Eggs are laid—and larvae can be found—in soil, rotten wood, or dung (which dung beetles roll into a ball and bury).



KHEPER AEGYPTIORUM

This is the large, colorful sacred scarab of Africa, probably the first to be revered in Ancient Egypt. It rolls dung into large balls, which it buries and in which it lays eggs.



CHRYSINA RESPLENDENS

Sometimes called precious metal scarabs due to their gold or silver coloring, this rare scarab and its relatives are found in South America.

POLYPHYLLA STARKAE

This beetle belongs to a genus of scarab beetles that occur across the Northern Hemisphere. They have their greatest diversity in southern USA. Described in 2009, this species was discovered on the Florida peninsula.

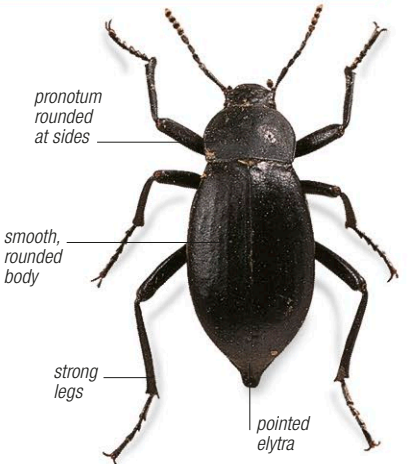
Family Tenebrionidae

Darkling beetles

Occurrence 17,000 spp. worldwide; on ground in all terrestrial habitats, especially in desert and arid regions



Darkling beetles vary considerably in color (black or brown body, or white elytra), shape (parallel-sided or large and oval), and texture (smooth and shiny or dull and rough). They are 1/16–2 in (0.2–5 cm) long. Many species have reduced hindwings and do not fly. These beetles eat decaying vegetable or animal matter, and some are pests of stored products. A few secrete a foul chemical repellent.



BLAPS MUCRONATA

The cellar, or churchyard, beetle is a nonflying, European species that favors dark places.